Open Ranks Inspection (ORI) Procedures

Reference: DAFPAM 34-1203, 13 September 2022

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**Falling In**

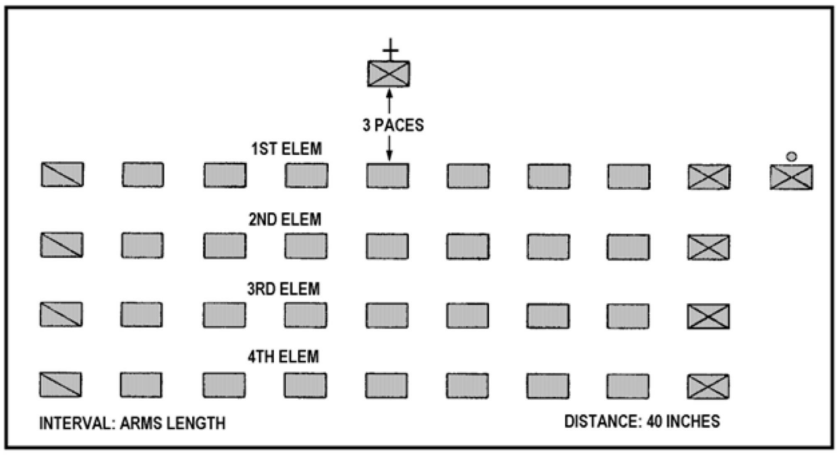
Command: *"FALL IN!"*

On this command, the Guidon Bearer takes a position facing the Flight Commander (FLT/CC), and to the FLT/CCs left so the first element will fall in centered on and three paces from the FLT/CC. If the flight has an even number of ranks (rows), the flight will be centered including the guidon bearer. If the flight has an odd number of ranks, the guidon bearer does not count toward the centering of the flight. Once halted at the position of attention, the Guidon Bearer performs an automatic *"dress right dress",* which includes keeping the guidon at the position of carry. When the Guidon Bearer feels the presence of the first Element Leader on their fingertips, the Guidon Bearer executes an automatic *"ready front"*. Once positioned, the Guidon Bearer does not move.

The first Element Leader falls in directly to the left of the guide and ONCE HALTED, executes an automatic *"dress right dress",* to include turning the head 45 degrees to the right and taking choppy steps to fix alignment. The correct order of these movements can be remembered with "**stop** (at attention), **pop** (up your arm), and **chop** (your feet to fix position)". The second, third, and fourth Element Leaders fall in behind the first Element Leader, execute an automatic *"dress right dress"* but will not turn their heads, visually establish a 40-inch distance, and align themselves directly behind the individual in front of them. The remaining members of the flight fall into the next available position to the left of the Element Leaders, one row at a time, and execute an automatic *"dress right dress"* to establish dress and cover. They will also execute an automatic *"ready front"* once they feel the presence of someone standing to their left. The distance between elements will be established by the "base file", which are the Element Leaders in this case. The interval will be established by the "leading individuals", which are the members of the first element in this case. All other members of the flight will align themselves according to those people. The final persons to join the flight will not put their left arm up when they execute *"dress right dress"*.

*See attachment below…*

**DAFPAM34-1203, 13 SEPT 22, Figure 4.1. Flight in Line Formation**




Note: Doing this right comes with practice, do not sprint to a part of the flight. Slow is smooth, smooth is fast.

**Sizing the Flight**

Command: *"Right, FACE!"* (Column formation)

Command: *"If you are taller than the airman/trainee/cadet in front of you, tap and move forward."*

> Upon hearing this command, the taller cadet will tap the shorter cadet on the shoulder using their right hand. The taller cadet will step forward to the right (at 45 degrees), and the shorter cadet will step backward to the left (at 45 degrees) in order to switch places.

Exceptions: Guidon Bearer and Element Leaders

Command: *"Right, FACE!"* (Inverse line)

Command: *"If you are taller than the airman/trainee/cadet in front of you, tap and move forward."*

Exceptions: No exceptions

Command: *"Left, FACE!"* (Column formation)

Command: *"If you are taller than the airman/trainee/cadet in front of you, tap and move forward."*

Exceptions: Guidon Bearer and Element Leaders

Note: The Deputy Flight Commander (FLT/CD) as an exception is completely optional for training purposes.

**Counting Off**

Command: *"Count, OFF!"*

On the *"OFF!"* portion of the command, all the Element Leaders say *"one"* in a normal conversational tone.

After the Element Leaders say *"one"*, members in the next file turn their heads and eyes in unison and say *"two"*. This procedure continues subsequently until all files, full or partial, are numbered. All movements are made in a precise manner with snap!

Exception: Guidon Bearer

Command: *"Count, OFF!" (Second time)*

Command: *"Left, FACE!"*

Note: For both "Sizing the Flight" and "Counting off" the FLT/CC is HIGHLY encouraged to march to a position of the flight to verify both are being executed properly.

Sizing the Flight:

FLT/CC will be in position behind the flight (whichever direction they are facing)

Counting Off:

FLT/CC will be 45 degrees in front of and to the right of the flight, facing them (while they are in column formation).

**Opening the Ranks**

The FLT/CC will march to a position directly next to the guidon bearer, take six paces forward, and then re-center themselves with the flight.

Command**:** *"Open ranks, MARCH!"*

Elements take as many steps forward as there are elements behind you.

For example (if fallen into four elements):

1st Element: three steps forward

2nd Element: two steps forward

3rd Element: one step forward

4th Element: automatic *"Dress, right dress"*

Note: There should be a 64 inch space between each element.

Directly after halting, the flight will pop their arms and turn their heads for a *"Dress, right dress",* to include the guidon bearer holding the guidon at the position of carry.

FLT/CC will then verify the alignment of each element, calling…

Command**:** *"Cadet/Trainee/Airman (number) move up/back".*

Note: There is no command *"steady"* and it will NOT be used.

To verify the alignment of each element: FLT/CC will stand to the side of the first element and correct the positioning of those cadets. The FLT/CC will then perform a left face, take three paces forward, perform a right face, and then take one small step to the right in order to correctly position themself to correct the next element. This process will be repeated for all remaining elements.

Once all elements are aligned, FLT/CC will march to a position one pace to the right and three paces in front of the guidon bearer, perform a "*left face"*, and call…

Command**:** *"Ready, FRONT!"*

**Inspection Execution**

Inspector Approach:

FLT/CC moves one pace forward and performs a right face. Positioning themselves DIRECTLY in front of the Guidon Bearer.

Upon the Inspector's approach, FLT/CC salutes and reports: *"Good Morning/Afternoon/Evening Sir/Ma'am, ____ Flight is prepared for inspection."*

Salute no matter the rank of the inspector.

The Inspector will respond: "Good *Morning/Afternoon/Evening, accompany me on this inspection."*

FLT/CC will then respond: *"Accompany you on this inspection. Yes Sir/Ma'am. Thank you Sir/Ma'am."*

FLT/CC will perform a *"left face"* and call…

Command: *"Second, third, and fourth elements, Parade, REST!"*

It will now be the responsibility of element leaders to call each element to the position of attention/parade rest.

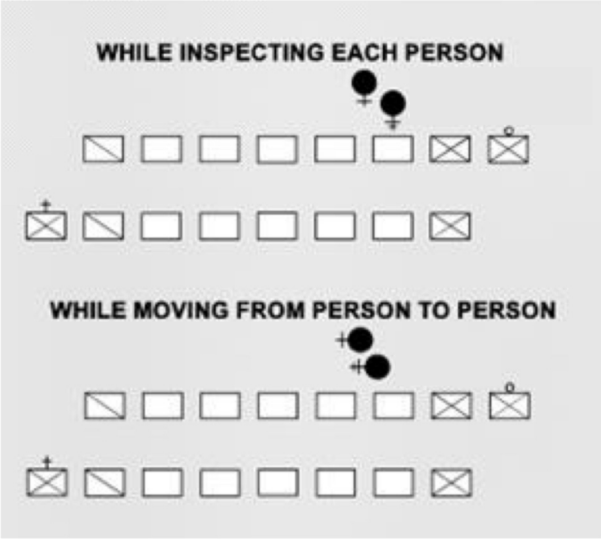
FLT/CC will automatically perform the *"diagonal three step"* to position themselves directly in front of the first Element Leader and one pace behind the Inspector. The *"diagonal three step"* involves taking one step that travels diagonally and turns the FLT/CC to face the first element, a second diagonal step, and a final step that brings the FLT/CC back to the position of attention.

Inspection Protocol:

The inspector checks uniform standards and appearance and may ask questions.

FLT/CC shadows (moves simultaneously with the) inspector, one pace to the right and one pace behind.

**DAFPAM34-1203, 13 SEPT 22, Figure 5.3. Inspection of the Squadron (EDITED FOR FLIGHTS)**




The Duck Walk:

With either a verbal or physical cue, the inspector will signal a "duck walk" to the next individual in the element.

Depending on the Inspector, they may call that individual to *"about face"* in order to inspect the rear of an individual's uniform.

The Last Individual in the Element/Cursory/To the End:

If the Inspector has inspected the last individual of the element OR calls either *"Cursory/To the End"*, both the FLT/CC and Inspector will perform a *"half duck walk"* directly into a *"forward march"* down the element.

To navigate down towards the next element, the Inspector will call a *"Left flank, MARCH!"*.

After the first *"Left flank"* is called an automatic second *"Left flank"* will be performed by both. Positioning the Inspector and the now trailing FLT/CC down the next element.

Automatic halts from the inspector can happen at any point to inspect the rear of the preceding element without a verbal cue; as FLT/CC, be vigilant.

Element Leaders will call their element to *"Attention!/Parade REST!"* once the inspector approaches/leaves their element. While calling these commands, Element Leaders will pin their heads 45 degrees to the left.

Typically, the Inspector will halt at the upcoming Element Leader. Once halted, the Inspector and FLT/CC will simultaneously perform a *"Right face"*. This will put them directly in front of the first two Cadets/Trainees/Airmen in this element.

FLT/CC will still be one step to the right and behind the Inspector.

Continue this execution until the entirety of the flight is inspected.

After every member of the flight has been inspected, the Inspector will move to a position (anywhere they please) prior to debriefing the FLT/CC.

FLT/CC will go directly three paces in front of the Guidon Bearer and perform a *"Left, face"* and call…

Command: *"Flight, ATTENTION!"*

The FLT/CC will now await the inspector for the debrief.

Once approached, the FLT/CC will now greet the inspector and say, *"Sir/Ma'am ____ Flight has completed the Open Ranks Inspection"*.

At this time, the Inspector will give noted discrepancies during this "reporting out" interaction.

FLT/CC will now perform a *"Left, face"*.

Command: *"REST!"* (the flight will stand at the position of *"Parade, rest"*, but be permitted to talk).

Lastly, the FLT/CC will move to the center of the flight and debrief any discrepancies noted or debriefed from the evaluator.

**Closing the Ranks**

Command: *"Flight, ATTENTION"*

Command: *"Close Ranks, MARCH!"*

For example (if fallen into four elements):

4th Element: 3 step forward

3rd Element: 2 steps forward

2nd Element: 1 step forward

1st Element: stands fast

Cadets/Trainees/Airmen resume attention.

Once *"Close ranks"* is executed, the FLT/CC will…

Command: *"Ready, FRONT!"*

Command: *"FALL OUT!"*

**Recording the Inspection**

If the inspection is to be recorded, the FLT/CC may take notes as long as they return to the proper position of attention before giving commands or moving. The FLT/CD will not be used for this purpose. For the inspection of a squadron, refer to DAFPAM 34-1203, 13 September 2022, Page 46. This is where a FLT/CD (optional) may take notes and accompany the inspection.